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**Integrated and coordinated implementation of and follow-up
to the outcomes of the major United Nations conferences and
summits in the economic, social and related fields**

Resolution adopted by the General Assembly on 20 May 2026

[without reference to a Main Committee (A/80/L.61)]

80/257. Fourth Industrial Development Decade for Africa (2026–2035)

The General Assembly,

Recalling its resolution [35/66 B](#) of 5 December 1980, in which it proclaimed the 1980s as the first Industrial Development Decade for Africa, its resolution [44/237](#) of 22 December 1989, in which it proclaimed the period 1991–2000 as the Second Industrial Development Decade for Africa, its resolution [47/177](#) of 22 December 1992, in which it adjusted the period for the programme for the Second Decade to cover the years 1993–2002, its resolution [57/297](#) of 20 December 2002 on the Second Decade, and its resolution [70/293](#) of 25 July 2016, by which it proclaimed the period 2016–2025 as the Third Industrial Development Decade for Africa,

Reaffirming its resolution [70/1](#) of 25 September 2015, entitled “Transforming our world: the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development”, which reflects the importance of industrial development to the 2030 Agenda, including Sustainable Development Goal 9, Build resilient infrastructure, promote inclusive and sustainable industrialization and foster innovation, and its interrelated targets,

Recognizing the interlinkages between Sustainable Development Goal 1 on ending poverty in all its forms and dimensions, including extreme poverty, acknowledged as the greatest global challenge and an indispensable requirement for sustainable development, and Sustainable Development Goal 9 on building resilient infrastructure, promoting inclusive and sustainable industrialization and fostering innovation, as well as their interrelated targets,

Recalling its other relevant resolutions on industrial development cooperation, particularly resolution [79/222](#) of 19 December 2024, which acknowledged the importance of sustained support for Africa’s industrialization and called for the proclamation of a fourth Industrial Development Decade for Africa to build on the achievements and lessons learned from previous Decades and to accelerate inclusive and sustainable industrial transformation across the continent,



Reaffirming its resolution 69/313 of 27 July 2015 on the Addis Ababa Action Agenda of the Third International Conference on Financing for Development, which is an integral part of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, supports and complements it, helps to contextualize its means of implementation targets with concrete policies and actions and reaffirms the strong political commitment to address the challenge of financing and creating an enabling environment at all levels for sustainable development in the spirit of global partnership and solidarity,

Welcoming the convening of the Fourth International Conference on Financing for Development from 30 June to 3 July 2025 in Sevilla, Spain, and reaffirming its outcome document, the Sevilla Commitment, endorsed by the General Assembly in its resolution 79/323 of 25 August 2025, which sets forth a renewed global framework for financing for development, building on the 2015 Addis Ababa Action Agenda,¹ to close with urgency the estimated annual 4 trillion United States dollar financing gap,² and catalyse sustainable development investments at scale in developing countries and continue the reform of the international financial architecture through continued and strong commitment to multilateralism, international cooperation, and global solidarity,

Stressing the importance of enhanced access to concessional and blended finance for African countries, in line with their development priorities,

Welcoming the convening of the Summit of the Future on 22–23 September 2024 at the United Nations Headquarters in New York, at which resolution 79/1 entitled “The Pact for the Future” and its annexes were adopted,

Welcoming also the convening of the Third United Nations Conference on Landlocked Developing Countries, and the Awaza Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries for the Decade 2024–2034,³

Recalling the Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries,⁴ and the Doha Political Declaration, adopted during the second part of the Fifth United Nations Conference on the Least Developed Countries, held in Doha from 5 to 9 March 2023,⁵ in which the Heads of State and Government and representatives of States strongly committed to the implementation of the Doha Programme of Action throughout the coming decade, including its six priority areas,

Recognizing the adoption of Agenda 2063 by the Assembly of Heads of State and Government of the African Union at its twenty-fourth ordinary session, held in Addis Ababa on 30 and 31 January 2015, as the African Union’s long-term political strategy for Africa’s development and its second 10-year implementation plan which outlines key flagship projects and programmes to be fast-tracked during the decade, and recognizing the commitment to the full implementation of the political declaration on Africa’s development needs, adopted on 22 September 2008,⁶ and acknowledging the catalytic role of the African Continental Free Trade Area in advancing industrial development by promoting regional value chains, boosting intra-African trade in manufactured goods and creating economies of scale and investment opportunities,

¹ General Assembly resolution 69/313, annex.

² *Financing for Sustainable Development Report 2024* (United Nations publication, 2024), figure I.1.

³ Resolution 79/233, annex; see also resolution 79/279.

⁴ Resolution 76/258, annex.

⁵ *Report of the Fifth United Nations Conference on the Least Developed Countries, New York, 17 March 2022, and Doha, 5–9 March 2023 (A/CONF.219/2023/3)*, chap. I, resolution 2.

⁶ Resolution 63/1.

Recognizing also the importance of supporting the African Union Agenda 2063 and its second 10-year implementation plan, as well as its continental programme embedded in relevant General Assembly resolutions on the New Partnership for Africa's Development, as well as relevant regional initiatives that emphasize the role of industrialization as a driver of economic diversification, value addition, job creation and sustainable structural economic transformation in Africa,

Welcoming the establishment of the African Union Development Agency-New Partnership for Africa's Development, following the decision at the thirty-first ordinary session of the Assembly of Heads of State and Government of the African Union in June 2018 to transform the New Partnership for Africa's Development Planning and Coordinating Agency into the African Union Development Agency,

Acknowledging the African Union Development Agency's pivotal role in coordinating and implementing the New Partnership for Africa's Development and related programmes, as reaffirmed in General Assembly resolutions on the New Partnership for Africa's Development, recognizing its contributions to advancing Africa's integration, industrialization and sustainable development through priority regional and continental initiatives, technical support to Member States and regional economic communities, and the incubation of innovative programmes in areas such as infrastructure, energy, digital economy, and natural resource governance, and acknowledging also that the African Union Development Agency serves as the continent's technical interface with development partners, aligned with Agenda 2063, and is instrumental in driving Africa's industrial and economic transformation,

Taking note of the outcomes of the 17th Extraordinary Summit of the African Union on Industrialization and Economic Diversification, held in Niamey in November 2022, which reaffirmed the centrality of industrialization to Africa's structural transformation and sustainable development, and recalling the decision of the Executive Council of the African Union, adopted in Addis Ababa, in February 2025, calling upon the General Assembly to proclaim the Fourth Industrial Development Decade for Africa, in support of the continent's industrial transformation agenda, in alignment with the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, Agenda 2063 and the objectives of the African Continental Free Trade Area,

Taking note also of the conclusions and recommendations of the strategic independent evaluation of the implementation of the Third Industrial Development Decade for Africa, undertaken in 2024, which underscored the role of the African Union, regional economic communities and African countries in the effective implementation of the Decade and emphasized the need for strengthened coordination, enhanced resource mobilization and results-oriented partnerships among African countries, regional institutions, the United Nations system, development partners, the private sector and other relevant stakeholders,

Recognizing the importance of a regional integration approach in Africa that effectively links trade, infrastructure and industrialization as foundational priorities for fostering economies of scale, enhancing productive capacities and increasing intra-African trade, and recognizing further that harmonized policies and coordinated investments across these interconnected priorities are essential to advancing inclusive and sustainable industrial development and accelerating Africa's economic transformation and integration within the global economy,

Recognizing also the importance of supporting countries in accelerating their efforts to eradicate poverty in all its forms and dimensions, including extreme poverty, and to promote the empowerment of the poor and people in vulnerable situations, including women, children and youth, Indigenous Peoples and local communities,

older persons, persons with disabilities, migrants, refugees and internally displaced persons and all low-income families,

Taking note of the outcome of the seventh high-level event on the Third Industrial Development Decade for Africa, organized jointly by the African Union Commission, the Economic Commission for Africa and the United Nations Industrial Development Organization, in partnership with the African Development Bank, the African Export-Import Bank and the African Business Council, held on the margins of the seventy-ninth session of the General Assembly on 25 September 2024, under the theme “Sustainable industry for Africa’s tomorrow: building resilience across generations”,

Reaffirming the role of inclusive and sustainable industrial development as a foundation for economic diversification, structural transformation, value addition, decent job creation, resilience-building and poverty eradication in Africa, and deeper regional integration, particularly through initiatives such as the African Continental Free Trade Area, which collectively contribute to the continent’s long-term development aspirations,

Recognizing the significant progress achieved under the Third Industrial Development Decade for Africa in advancing inclusive and sustainable industrialization across the continent, while acknowledging the persistent challenges, including limited productive capacity, infrastructure deficits, low levels of technology transfer, constrained access to finance, and inadequate industrial skills and capabilities, that continue to hinder structural transformation and economic diversification in African countries,

Acknowledging the joint effort of the African Union Commission, the African Union Development Agency, the Economic Commission for Africa, the United Nations Industrial Development Organization and the African Development Bank in implementing the Decade, in close cooperation with African countries, the regional economic communities, the African Continental Free Trade Area secretariat, the African Export-Import Bank, development partners and the private sector,

1. *Proclaims* the period 2026–2035 as the Fourth Industrial Development Decade for Africa, with the aim of accelerating inclusive, sustainable and resilient industrial transformation across the African continent;

2. *Calls upon* the African Union Commission, the African Union Development Agency-New Partnership for Africa’s Development, the Economic Commission for Africa and, specifically, the United Nations Industrial Development Organization, to develop, operationalize and lead the implementation of the Fourth Industrial Development Decade for Africa (2026–2035) in accordance with its mandate, and through voluntary contributions, in collaboration with relevant United Nations entities, regional economic communities, development finance institutions, the private sector and other stakeholders, in alignment with Agenda 2063 and the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development,⁷ while promoting synergy, coherence and accountability in delivering results at the national, regional and continental levels;

3. *Encourages* the Director General of the United Nations Industrial Development Organization to mobilize adequate resources for the implementation of the Fourth Decade;

4. *Reiterates* that African countries have primary responsibility for their own economic and social development and that the role of national policies and development strategies cannot be overemphasized, bearing in mind the need for their

⁷ Resolution 70/1.

development efforts to be supported by an enabling international economic environment;

5. *Invites*, as appropriate, the United Nations Industrial Development Organization, as the United Nations specialized agency for industrialization, in close collaboration with the African Union, to scale up its technical assistance to African countries in accordance with its mandate to promote inclusive and sustainable industrial development for the successful implementation of the Fourth Decade;

6. *Also invites* the United Nations Industrial Development Organization to foster partnerships, as appropriate, with other relevant entities in the United Nations development system, such as the United Nations Conference on Trade and Development, the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations, the International Labour Organization, the United Nations Environment Programme, the World Bank, the International Monetary Fund and the United Nations Development Programme, and to promote the necessary linkages to develop joint initiatives in favour of industrialization, including technology transfer, on mutually agreed terms, access to information and communications technology, productive diversification, agribusiness value chain development, trade, capacity-building, renewable energy and energy efficiency, industrial policy, special economic zones and industrial parks, action on climate change and human capital development, while also strengthening public-private partnerships with a range of stakeholders, including those in the public and the private sectors, civil society organizations and academia;

7. *Calls for* enhanced international cooperation, including North-South, South-South and triangular cooperation, in support of Africa's industrialization, including through the implementation of the Fourth Decade, and reaffirms that South-South cooperation is not a substitute for, but is rather a complement to, North-South cooperation;

8. *Invites* the international community, particularly bilateral and multilateral partners, the United Nations system, global and regional financial institutions, in particular the World Bank, the International Monetary Fund, the New Development Bank and the African Development Bank, in accordance with their respective mandates, to ensure full support for the implementation of programmes for the Fourth Decade at the national and subregional levels;

9. *Requests* the Secretary-General to support, within existing resources, the United Nations Industrial Development Organization in its assistance to the African Union, African countries and regional organizations in the implementation of programmes for the Fourth Decade;

10. *Emphasizes* the importance of allowing sufficient time between the proclamation and the commencement of implementation to facilitate inclusive and comprehensive consultations, coordination and planning at the national, regional and international levels, ensuring the preparation, endorsement and launch of a well-aligned, results-oriented work programme for Africa's industrial transformation;

11. *Expresses its commitment* to the collective implementation of the Fourth Industrial Development Decade for Africa, as a contribution to the realization of Agenda 2063;

12. *Calls upon* all Member States, the private sector and civil society to actively engage in the implementation of the Fourth Industrial Development Decade for Africa, recognizing its centrality to achieving sustainable and inclusive economic transformation on the continent, and urges the international community to continue and enhance support for Africa's industrialization efforts, aligning their strategies with those of national Governments and regional and continental intergovernmental

organizations, including through financial and technical assistance, trade facilitation, investment promotion, capacity-building and access to science, technology and innovation;

13. *Emphasizes* the importance of regional integration, including through the African Continental Free Trade Area, in alignment with the goals of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, as well as the goals to ensure coherence with the aspirations of the African people as reflected in Agenda 2063, as a foundation for advancing industrialization and economic transformation in Africa;

14. *Encourages* the establishment of national and regional industrial development programmes to integrate industrialization along strategic transport corridors, support value chain development, foster innovation, enhance technological capabilities and develop competitive industries, while creating decent jobs and ensuring social inclusivity;

15. *Reaffirms* the necessity of a strong enabling environment for industrial development, including sound economic policies, quality, reliable, sustainable and resilient infrastructure, skilled labour, improved access to finance, and enhanced regional and global connectivity, to advance inclusive and sustainable industrialization in Africa;

16. *Encourages* the strengthening of monitoring and reporting at the national level on the implementation of the Fourth Industrial Development Decade for Africa, including through existing reporting mechanisms;

17. *Decides* to include in the provisional agenda of its eighty-fifth session, under the item entitled “Eradication of poverty and other development issues”, a sub-item entitled “Fourth Industrial Development Decade for Africa (2026–2035)”;

18. *Requests* the Director General of the United Nations Industrial Development Organization to submit to the General Assembly at its eighty-fifth session, through the Secretary-General, a progress report on the implementation of the Fourth Decade.

*82nd plenary meeting
20 May 2026*